ALLEGHENY MILLWORK

COLD STRESS PREVENTION PLAN

Interior Finish Trades – Division 06: Rough & Finish Carpentry/Architectural Millwork

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Site Specific Health & Safety Program

Cold Weather Operations (Typically November – March)

Project Name	
Project Address	
General Contractor	
Superintendent	
Effective Date	

104 Commerce Blvd. | Lawrence, PA 15055

COLD STRESS PREVENTION PLAN

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PURPOSE

This Cold Stress Prevention Plan establishes the minimum requirements that Allegheny Millwork follows to protect workers engaged in Division 06 Interior Finish Trades from the hazards of cold-induced illness and injury while working inside building enclosures that are not yet fully heated. The plan fulfills the employer's General Duty obligation under Section 5(a)(1) of the Occupational Safety and Health Act (OSHA), and aligns with 29 CFR 1910.132 (PPE), 29 CFR 1910.151 (first aid), 29 CFR 1904 (recordkeeping), OSHA's published cold-stress guidance, and ACGIH Threshold Limit Values (TLVs®) for Cold Stress.

SCOPE

This plan applies to all employees, subcontractors, installers and site visitors performing or observing Division 06 work, including by not limited to:

- Installation of standing and running trim, door and window casings, base, crown, chair rail and wainscot.
- Installation of stile-and-rail and flat-panel paneling, wall cladding and ceiling treatments.
- Fabrication touch-up and field installation of architectural cabinetry, built-ins, reception desks and judges' benches.
- Installation of stair parts, handrails, newels, balustrades and ornamental millwork.
- Installation of solid surface, stone and wood countertops associated with millwork.
- Field finishing operations (sanding, staining, clear-coating) performed in cold environments.
- Unloading, handling and onsite staging of finished millwork packages.

SCOPE EXCLUSIONS

This plan is intentionally focused on interior work. The following activities require a separate or supplemental cold-weather exposure assessment:

- Exterior trim, soffits, fascia or exterior architectural woodwork installed from the building exterior or exposed rooftops.
- Work on pavilions, porches or other uncovered structures.

Workers who transition between these exterior activities to the interior scope covered here must be protected under both plans for the duration of their exterior exposure.

COLD STRESS DEFINED

Cold stress occurs when the body is unable to maintain its normal core temperature of 98.6°F (37°C). Contributing factors include air temperature, wind speed, wetness (from precipitation, sweat or wet finishes), duration of exposure, worker physical condition and personal protective equipment. For finish carpenters, additional risk factors include prolonged stationary posture during precise installation, reduced dexterity from gloves and contact cooling from metal tools and cold material surfaces.

COLD STRESS IN THE INTERIOR FINISH ENVIRONMENT

Unlike structural trades, finish carpentry and architectural millwork installation presents several cold stress conditions that require specific management:

- Sustained exposure at 35-55°F for an eight (80 hour shift produces meaningful core-temperature drop, especially in stationary installation tasks.
- Work is frequently performed inside building enclosures that are not yet heated and may draft aggressively through unfinished openings.
- Concrete slabs and masonry walls act as massive heat sinks, drawing heat from kneeling workers and from any person or tool in contact with them.
- Finish trades work almost exclusively with bare or lightly-gloved hands to maintain 1/32" tolerances. Finger temperature is the primary risk, not necessarily the core temperature.
- Temporary heaters introduce their own hazards (CO, combustion gases, fire) that must be managed alongside cold stress controls.
- Architectural millwork is moisture and temperature sensitive; protecting the product often drives HVAC commissions which in turn affects worker exposure.
- Solvent-based finishes, contact cements and adhesives have minimum application temperatures that often conflict with ambient conditions.
- Loose fitting clothing, drawstrings and scarves pose an entanglement hazard around table saws, routers and miter saws. Cold weather dress must balance warmth against machine safety.

DEFINITIONS & KEY TERMS

The following terms are used throughout this plan:

Term	Definition
Cold Stress	Physiological strain resulting from exposure to cold air, water or surfaces that reduces body core or extremity temperature.
Core Body Temperature	Internal temperature of the body, normally 98.6°F (37°C). Hypothermia is defined as core temperatures at or below 95°F (35°C).
Indoor Ambient Temperature	The dry-bulb air temperature measured a the point of work, at breathing height (approximately 5 foot above the finished floor).
Effective Indoor Temperature	The perceived temperature adjusted for drafts from unsealed openings & radiant loss to cold slabs & walls. A draft of 5 mph through an open door reduces effective indoor temperature by approximately 6-8°F.
Hypothermia	A medical emergency in which the body loses heat faster than it can produce it, resulting in core temperatures below 95°F (35°C).
Frostbite	The freezing of skin & underlying tissues. In interior work, fingers are the dominant site due to handling of cold fasteners, metal tools and stone/metal surfaces.
Contact Cooling Injury	Rapid loss of skin heat or tissue damage from touching cold metal, stone or other high-conductivity surfaces, possible even before freezing.
Trench Foot (Immersion Foot)	Non-freezing cold injury of the feet caused by the prolonged exposure to wet & cold, possible in temperatures as high as 60°F (16°C).
Competent Person (CP)	One who is capable of identifying existing & predictable cold stress hazards & whom has the authorization to take prompt corrective measures.
Warming Area	An enclosed, heated space maintained at or above 60°F (16°C), used for scheduled & as needed rewarming breaks.
Building Enclosure Status	The level of weather tightness of the area where interior finish work is performed: a. Fully enclosed & heated b. Fully enclosed, unheated c. Partially enclosed (open door/window openings) d. Not enclosed
Acclimatization	Physiological adjustment to cold exposure achieved gradually over 1-2 weeks of repeated exposure.

ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

PROJECT MANAGER

- Ensure this plan is implemented, reviewed and updated annually or when conditions change.
- Allocate resources for warming facilities, PPE, heaters and temporary enclosures.
- Coordinate with the General Contractor to sequence interior finish work after building is dried-in and temporary heat is available, whenever feasible.
- Confirm building enclosure status in writing before crews mobilize to a finish area.
- Provide the resources for warming areas, temporary heat, PPE and product conditioning.
- Maintain records of training, exposure events and incidents for at least three (3) years.

SUPERINTENDENT/COMPETENT PERSON

- Conduct pre-shift weather assessments and determine the applicable work/warm-up schedule.
- Inspect warming areas, heaters, PPE and fuel storage daily.
- Verify temporary heaters are operating, CO monitors are active and warming areas are at least ≥68°F.
- Walk the finish area with crew before the shift begins; identify drafty openings, cold slabs and any zone requiring supplemental controls.
- Authorize work stoppage when conditions exceed the limits of the Environmental Action Levels.
- Observe workers throughout the shift for early signs of cold stress.
- Document weather readings, acclimatization status of new or returning workers and any cold related incidents in the Daily Log (Appendix A).

EMPLOYEES

- Report to work properly dressed per the suggested PPE and work clothing guidelines and with personal insulated gear in serviceable condition.
- Use warming areas and breaks as scheduled; do not skip breaks to accelerate installation.
- Watch assigned buddy for signs of cold stress and report immediately to the Superintendent/ Competent Person.
- Report wet clothing, loss of dexterity, numbness, shivering or unusual fatigue without delay.
- Never use open flame heaters or salamanders without the Superintendent/Competent Persons authorization and a completed hot-work permit.

SAFETY MANAGER

- Audit plan implementation periodically and after any incident.
- Deliver or arrange annual cold stress training per the training guidelines.
- Maintain calibration records for interior temperature, humidity and CO monitors.
- Coordinate emergency response drills involving cold-related illnesses.

SUBCONTRACTORS, INSTALLERS & VISITORS

- Acknowledge this plan in writing prior to performing Division 06 Installation Work.
- Provide their own cold weather PPE unless contractually specified otherwise.
- Comply with all stop-work and work/warm-up directives from the Superintendent/Competent Person.

HAZARD ASSESSMENT

A cold stress hazard assessment shall be performed for each phase of Division 06 installation. The table below summarizes recurring hazards for typical installation activities and shall be expanded in the site-specific Activity Hazard Analysis (AHA) for each task.

Activity	Primary Cold Stress Hazard	Aggravating Factors
Unloading Millwork Crates at Loading Dock	• Wind Chill • Wet Gloves from Frost on Packaging	• Early Morning Shifts • Continuous Exposure >20 Minutes
Field Measuring in Unheated Spaces	• Reduced Dexterity • Extremity Cooling	• Stationary Posture • Contact with Cold Steel Tapes/Squares
Installing Base, Casing, Crown (Stationary, Hand-Nailing/Pinning)	• Loss of Finger Dexterity • Contact Cooling from Fasteners	• Kneeling of Cold Concrete • Drafts from Unsealed Openings
Cutting at Miter Saw Station (Outdoor/Tented)	• Wind Exposure • Entanglement Risk from Loose Outerwear	• Loose Scarves, Hoods or Drawstrings Near Blade Guards
Paneling & Wall Cladding Installation	• Prolonged Elevated Arm Work in Cold • Reduced Circulation	• Scaffold or Lift Work Exposes Worker to Wind at Height
Cabinetry Installation (Kitchens, Vanities, Casework)	• Stationary Posture in Unheated Rough-Ins	• Concrete Slab Pre-Conditioning • Glue/Adhesive Temperature Limits
Stair & Handrail Installation	• Fall Hazard Compounded by Stiffness & Bulky Clothing	• Ice on Stair Treads • Reduced Tactile Feedback
Field Staining/Finishing	• Solvent Inhalation Combined with Closed Space Heating	• CO/CO_2 Buildup from Unvented Heaters
Punch List Touch-Up	• Repeated Short Exposures Without Full Rewarming	• Travelling Between Heated & Unheated Zones

RECOGNIZING SIGNS & SYMPTOMS

Allegheny Millwork values the health and safety of all of its employees, subcontractors and installers, especially while on a jobsite. Because interior finish workers are not exposed to severe outdoor cold, symptoms often appear subtly are mistaken for ordinary fatigue. All workers shall be trained to recognize the following progression. The first person to identify symptoms, whether in themselves or a coworker, is obligated to stop work and notify the Superintendent/Competent Person immediately.

Early Indicators Specific to Interior Finish Work

- Difficulty picking up finish nails or screws from the belt.
- Repeated drops of small tools (pencils, chisels, block planes).
- Loss of fine-tuning ability at the miter saw (can't dial in the last 0.5").
- Uncharacteristic installation errors (reversed miters, incorrect reveal).
- Cold, white or waxy fingertips; persistent numbness after a 5 minute rewarming.

Hypothermia: Progressive Stages

- Mild (95°F - 91°F Core): Shivering, rapid breathing, numbness in extremities, mild clumsiness, impatience, impaired judgment
- Moderate (90°F - 82°F): Violent then diminishing shivering, stumbling, slurred speech, withdrawal, blue lips/fingers
- Severe (<82°F Core): Shivering stops, loss of consciousness, shallow breathing, weak pulse. **THIS IS A LIFE-THREATENING EMERGENCY**.

Frostbite/Contact Cooling Injury

- Frostnip: Skin red, tingling, cold. No tissue damage when rewarmed gently.
- Superficial Frostbite: Skin white or greyish-yellow, waxy, hard on surface but soft underneath; numb.
- Deep Frostbite: Skin & underlying tissue hard & pale/bluish. Joints & muscles may not work. Blisters after rewarming.
- Contact Cooling Burn: Sharp pain or numbness at the point of contact with cold stone or metal, possible even above freezing.

Trench Foot

- Feet that are Red, Numb or Swollen after prolonged wet-cold exposure (possible at temperatures as high as 60°F (16°C).
- Leg cramps, blisters/ulcers, bleeding under the skin in severe cases.

INTERIOR ACTION LEVELS & WORK/WARM-UP SCHEDULE

PRE-SHIFT WEATHER ASSESSMENT

The Superintendent/Competent Person shall measure and record the following at the start of each shift, at each active finish area, using a calibrated thermo-hygrometer and an anemometer or ribbon draft indicator:

- Dry-bulb air temperature at 5 ft above the finished floor.
- Floor-level temperature (where kneeling/baseboard work is planned).
- Relative humidity (for millwork product protection as well as worker comfort).
- Presence and source of any perceptible draft (>2 mph indoors).
- Building enclosure status (A/B/C/D — see Section 2).
- CO level at temporary heater discharge and at the warming area.

Findings are recorded on the Daily Cold-Stress Log (Appendix A) and reviewed during the morning safety briefing. Readings shall be repeated mid-shift or after any change (door removed, heater fuel-out, wind shift).

ACTION LEVELS: INTERIOR FINISH AREAS

Action Levels are established based on equivalent wind-chill temperature. The following table is the primary decision matrix for Division 06 field operations:

Effective Interior Temperature	Action Level	Required Controls
Above 60°F	Normal	• Standard PPE • No Cold-Specific Controls • Verify Building Humidity is Within Millwork Specification
55°F to 60°F	Advisory	• Light Insulating Layer Available • Thin Liner Gloves for Dexterity Tasks • Warming Area Accessible • Superintendent/Competent Person Monitors Finger Dexterity
45°F to 54°F	Caution	• Formal Work/Warm-Up Schedule • Close Drafty Openings • Dry Spare Gloves on Person • Heated Warming Area within 5 Min Travel
35°F to 44°F	Warning	• Supplemental Temporary Heat Installed in Finish Area • Only Essential Interior Finish Work Proceeds • Two-Person Minimum • Dedicated Observer • Installation of Moisture-Sensitive Architectural Woodwork is Suspended.
Below 35°F	STOP WORK (Non-Emergency)	• Interior Finish Work is Suspended Until Supplemental Heat Brings the Area Above 45°F • Finished Architectural Woodwork Shall Not Remain in an Area below 35°F due to Product Damage Risk

INTERIOR WORK/WARM-UP SCHEDULE

The following schedule applies to light to moderate interior finish work. Warm-up breaks shall be taken in a heated area maintained at ≥68°F (20°C). The schedule is adapted from ACGIH TLVS® for Cold Stress and calibrated for indoor, low-wind, sustained-exposure conditions typical of interior finish trades.

Effective Interior Temperature	Max Continuous Work Period	Warming Breaks per 4 Hour Block	Required Break Duration
55 – 60°F (Advisory)	Normal	Normal Breaks	Normal
50 – 54°F (Caution)	90 Minutes	1 Warming Break	10 Minutes
45 – 49°F (Caution)	75 Minutes	2 Warming Break	10 Minutes
40 – 44°F (Warning)	55 Minutes	3 Warming Break	10 Minutes
35 – 39°F (Warning)	40 Minutes	4 Warming Break	15 Minutes
Below 35°F (Danger)	Non-Emergency Work Suspended	N/A	N/A

Notes on Application:

- For heavy work (handling large casework, setting stone tops), move one row to a more protective schedule.
- For unacclimatized workers (first 5 working days), move one row to a more protective schedule.
- If a worker's clothing becomes wet from finishing materials, adhesives or slab condensation, they shall change immediately regardless of schedule.
- Where perceptible drafts exceed 2 mph at the workstation, erect a barrier or move one row to a more protective schedule.

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT & CLOTHING

DRESSING FOR INTERIOR COLD: DEXTERITY FIRST

Interior finish workers are not dressing for sub-zero exposure; they are dressing for an 8-hour shift at 40–55 °F while performing tolerance-critical hand work. The layering must warm the body without blocking the hands, and must not interfere with machine safety.

- Base Layer (Wicking): lightweight polyester or merino wool; no cotton, which loses insulation value when damp from exertion.
- Mid Layer (Insulating): fleece or wool pullover; thickness scaled to the action level.
- Shell: snug-fitting fleece or soft-shell jacket without loose cords, long scarves, or oversized hoods. A bulky outer parka is generally not appropriate in interior finish work due to machine entanglement risk and reduced arm mobility.
- Bottoms: insulated work pant; cotton carpenter jeans are discouraged below 50°F.
- Layers shall be adjustable without removing PPE so workers can vent during exertion and re-close during stationary installation.

HAND PROTECTION: THE GOVERNING ISSUE

Finger dexterity is the defining constraint for interior finish work. The hierarchy is:

- Measuring, Layout, Trim Detailing, Hardware Install: thin (≤0.8mm) nitrile or PU dipped glove with tactile fingertips. Swap to bare hand only for the few seconds needed and rewarm between uses.
- Nailing, Pinning, Biscuit Joining, Clamping: snug fleece-lined mechanic glove with reinforced fingertips.
- Handling Cold Stone, Quartz, or Stainless Countertops: insulated cut-resistant glove (ANSI A4 or higher) with thermal liner.
- Finish Application (Stains, Lacquers): solvent-resistant chemical-glove per the product SDS, worn over the base glove where hand cooling is also a concern.
- **EVERY** worker shall have at least one spare pair of dry gloves staged at the warming area at all times.
- **SAFETY RULE**: loose-cuffed insulated gloves shall NOT be worn at table saws, miter saws, shapers, or routers. Cuffs must be snug and confirmed outside the blade path before each cut.

HEAD, FACE & NECK

- Interior knit cap or hard-hat winder liner (knit type) certified for use with the issued hard hat. Do NOT modify the hard-hat suspension.
- Neck gaiter (snug, tubular) permitted in interior finish work. Loose scarves and drawstrings are PROHIBITED in the tool-use zone.
- Anti-fog safety glasses or goggles rated ANSI Z87.1+; pause at cold/warm transitions to allow lenses to clear before approaching running equipment.

FOOT PROTECTION & KNEELING

- Insulated work boot rated to at least 200 g Thinsulate™ (or equivalent), meeting ASTM F2413 for impact/compression.
- Wool or synthetic socks; carry at least one spare pair for a mid-shift change. Wet feet from slab moisture is the leading cause of interior trench-foot cases.
- Insulated or closed-cell-foam kneepads shall be used for all base, stair-stringer, and low-cabinet work. Bare knees on a concrete slab will cool the core within minutes.
- Insulated kneeling mats or knee creepers are required for sustained (>30 min) floor-level installation.

PPE ISSUED VS. WORKER-SUPPLIED

Unless otherwise specified in the project Health & Safety Plan, Allegheny Millwork will provide the following PPE to all employees:

- Hard Hat Winter Liners
- Insulated Task-Specific Gloves
- Neck Gaiters
- Chemical Hand Warmers
- Insulated Kneeling Mats
- Dry Glove Exchange Inventory at each warming area

Base layers, socks and boots are employee supplied, subject to pre-shift inspection by the Superintendent/ Competent Person.

ENGINEERING & ADMINISTRATIVE CONTROLS

ENCLOSURE & TEMPORARY HEAT (INTERIOR FOCUS)

The preferred control is to perform interior finish work only after the building is dried-in and temporary heat is commissioned. Where scheduling requires earlier installation:

- Confirm building enclosure status (A/B/C/D) with the General Contractor in writing before mobilizing to a finish area.
- Close or cover all unsealed openings (doors, windows, penetrations) in the active finish zone to eliminate drafts.
- Seal elevator shafts, stair shafts, and vertical chases that are acting as chimneys drawing cold air through the finish area.
- Commission temporary partitions to divide the finish zone from adjacent unheated construction.

HEATER SELECTION FOR INTERIOR FINISH WORK

- INDIRECT-FIRED heat is preferred in interior finish areas. Indirect-fired units exhaust combustion gases outside the occupied space, preserving indoor air quality and protecting finish materials from moisture and soot.
- DIRECT-FIRED forced-air heaters ("torpedo"/"salamander") introduce combustion by-products **AND** water vapor into the finish area. They are generally **NOT** acceptable around installed architectural woodwork because added moisture damages veneers and joinery, and they are only permitted in interior finish areas with active CO monitoring, manufacturer-specified fresh-air make-up, written Superintendent/Competent Person approval and a current hot-work permit.
- Electric resistance or hydronic heat is preferred around installed architectural woodwork; no combustion by-products, no added moisture.
- Target ambient in Division 06 finish areas: 55-70 °F dry-bulb with relative humidity 25-55%, consistent with AWI Architectural Woodwork Standards jobsite requirements.
- Carbon monoxide monitors with an audible alarm shall be placed at worker breathing height in every finish area served by any combustion heater. Alarm set-point: 35 ppm (8-hour TWA) with evacuation at 50 ppm.
- Fuel (propane cylinders, kerosene) shall be stored outside the building enclosure, never in the finish area or warming area.

DRAFT & SLAB-COOLING CONTROLS

- Install heavy-duty zipper doors at openings between heated finish zones & unheated construction.
- Use Visqueen sheeting and rigid-foam wall panels to temporarily close window and door openings that cannot be permanently sealed yet.
- Provide rigid-foam kneeling pads and rubber floor runners over concrete slabs in heavy kneeling areas (base installation, lower-cabinet work).
- Use radiant panel heaters aimed at worker kneeling positions for stationary tasks where zone heating is insufficient.

WARMING AREAS

- At least one heated warming shall be provided within a five (5) minute walk of every active Division 06 finish zone, inside the building envelope.
- Warming areas shall be maintained at ≥68°F (20°C), windproof, provide seating and dispense hot (non-caffeinated, non-alcoholic) beverages.
- Warming areas shall stock:
  - Dry Glove Exchange Bin
  - Chemical Hand Warmers
  - First-Aid Kit with Space Blanket
  - Daily Cold Stress Log
  - Posted Emergency Contacts
  - Active CO Monitor
- Warming areas shall be located such that workers do not need to transit any unheated zone to reach them.

WORK SCHEDULING

- Schedule moisture and temperature sensitive architectural woodwork installation (veneered paneling, sold wood raised panels) for after temporary heat has stabilized the area at 55-70°F, and 25-55% RH for at least 72 Hours.
- Rotate workers among cold exposed and warmer zone tasks to equalize exposure.
- Pair new hires and returning workers with experienced installers during the 1-2 week acclimatization period, reduce their continuous cold exposure by approximately 50% during that period.

BUDDY SYSTEM

A two-person minimum shall apply whenever effective interior temperature is at the Caution or Warning level, or when a single worker is assigned to an isolated interior location (mechanical room casework, closed stairwell handrail, equipment-room paneling). Buddies shall check each other every 30 minutes for cold-stress signs, wet clothing, and responsiveness.

HYDRATION & NUTRITION

- Drink 1 cup (8 oz) of warm, non-caffeinated fluid every hour; indoor cold exposure still causes dehydration, which is under-recognized.
- Eat warm, carbohydrate-rich meals and snacks; the body needs additional calories to maintain core temperature even indoors.
- Alcohol is prohibited during the work shift — it causes peripheral vasodilation that accelerates core heat loss.
- Nicotine reduces peripheral circulation; workers are encouraged to limit use during cold-exposure shifts.

MATERIAL & TOOL CONDITIONING

- Store fasteners, hardware, and small metal components in the warming area overnight. Cold fasteners cause contact-cooling injuries to fingers and may shatter brad-nailer tips.
- Bring solvent-based finishes, construction adhesives, contact cements and caulks to the manufacturer-specified application temperature in a conditioned storage area; read each SDS and Technical Data Sheet.
- Acclimate architectural millwork to interior conditions for a minimum of 72 hours prior to installation, or per manufacturer/AWI specification, to prevent post-installation movement.
- Inspect pneumatic hoses for cold-induced cracking; use winter-grade pneumatic tool oil.
- Battery-powered tool performance drops at low temperatures; keep spare batteries in an interior pocket or in the warming area.
- Stone, quartz, and solid-surface tops shall be moved into the conditioned interior at least 24 hours before setting to reduce contact-cooling risk and to meet adhesive manufacturer requirements.

EMERGENCY RESPONSE

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Post the completed Appendix B at every warming area before work begins:

Emergency (Police/Fire/EMS):	911
Nearest Hospital ER:	
Nearest Urgent Care:	
Project Superintendent:	
Site Safety Representative:	
Poison Control:	1-800-222-1222

FIRST AID FOR COLD RELATED ILLNESS & INJURY

Condition	Immediate First Aid	Escalation
Frostnip (Red, Tingling Fingers)	• Move to Warm Area • Rewarm with skin-to-skin contact or warm (not hot) water • Do not Rub	If Symptoms Persist >30 Minutes, treat as Frostbite
Superficial/Deep Frostbite (White, Waxy or Hard Skin)	• Move to Warm Area • Remove Wet Clothing • Do NOT Rub or Massage • Do NOT Rewarm if Refreezing is Possible • Cover with Loose, Dr, Sterile Dressing • Pad Between Fingers/Toes	Call 911. Transport to ER. Keep Victim Warm & Still
Contact-Cooling Injury (Cold Metal/Stone burn)	• Move to Warm Area • Rewarm the Affected Skin Gently • Treat Any Resulting Blister as a Burn	Refer to Clinic if Skin is Broken or Blistered
Mild Hypothermia (Shivering, Clumsy, Confused)	• Move to Warm Area • Remove Wet Clothing, Replace with Dry • Wrap in Blankets • Give Warm, Sweet, Non-Caffeinated Fluids if Fully Alert	Call 911 if Symptoms Do Not Improve Rapidly. Monitor Continuously

Condition	Immediate First Aid	Escalation
Moderate/Severe Hypothermia (Shivering Stops, Unresponsive, Slow Pulse)	• Call 911 IMMEDIATELY. • Handle Gently – Rough Handling can Trigger Cardiac Arrest • Do NOT Give Fluids by Mouth • Insulate from Ground • Apply Warm Packs to Neck, Armpits, Groin Only • Begin CPR if no Pulse After 30-45 Second Check	LIFE THREATENING. CALL 911 IMMEDIATELY. DO NOT DELAY EMS
Trench Foot (Red, Numb, Swollen Feet After Wet Exposure)	• Remove Wet Footwear & Socks • Dry Feet Thoroughly • Apply Warm Packs Loosely	Refer to Clinic/ER Worker Shall Not Return to Wet-Cold Exposure Until Cleared
CO Exposure (Headache, Dizziness, Nausea Near Heater)	• Evacuate to Fresh Air IMMEDIATELY. • Shut Off Suspect Heater if Safe to do so • Activate 911	All Exposed Workers Must be Medically Evaluated Heater Must be Locked Out Until Inspected

EMERGENCY EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST

- First-aid kit with space (mylar) blankets, chemical heat packs, sterile dressings, and scissors to cut away wet or contaminated clothing.
- AED within 3-minute retrieval time, tested monthly.
- CO monitor with audible alarm in every finish area served by combustion heat.
- Communication device capable of reaching both internal site contacts and external 911 from all finish zones.
- Means to egress the building to outside air within 60 seconds from any finish zone (CO response).

RETURN TO WORK AFTER A COLD-RELATED INCIDENT

- No worker who has experienced hypothermia, moderate/severe frostbite, or CO poisoning shall return to cold-exposed work without written clearance from a licensed healthcare provider.
- After clearance, the worker shall be reintroduced to cold exposure using an abbreviated acclimatization schedule (50% of the work/warm-up schedule exposure for 5 consecutive working days).

INCIDENT REPORTING & RECORDKEEPING

- All cold-stress incidents, including first-aid-only events, shall be reported to the Competent Person within 15 minutes of occurrence and documented on the project Incident Report form before end of shift.
- Recordable injuries (medical treatment beyond first aid, restricted work, lost time) shall be entered on the OSHA 300 log per 29 CFR 1904.
- Any in-patient hospitalization, amputation, or loss of an eye resulting from cold exposure or CO exposure must be reported to OSHA within 24 hours; a fatality must be reported within 8 hours.
- Cold-stress records (Daily Logs, training records, incident reports, heater/CO-monitor inspections) shall be retained for at least three (3) years, or longer where contractually required.
- Near-miss events involving cold stress or CO alarms shall be documented to identify trends and drive plan improvement.

TRAINING

REQUIRED TRAINING TOPICS

All Division 06 interior finish workers shall receive cold-stress training before initial cold-weather assignment and annually thereafter. Training shall be delivered in a language and at a literacy level understood by each worker, and shall cover:

1. The nature of cold stress, risk factors, and how the body loses heat in an indoor environment.
2. Recognition of early signs specific to interior finish work (dexterity loss, tool drops, installation errors) as well as classical hypothermia/frostbite signs.
3. Contents and application of this plan: interior action levels, work/warm-up schedule, buddy system, and warming-area use.
4. Proper selection, use, inspection, and care of cold-weather PPE while emphasizing dexterity-first glove selection and machine-safety interaction.
5. Safe use, fueling, and ventilation requirements of temporary heaters, including carbon monoxide recognition and response.
6. Importance of hydration, nutrition, and avoidance of alcohol/nicotine during cold exposure — even indoors.
7. Product-protection requirements: how ambient conditions for worker safety align with AWI requirements for architectural woodwork.
8. Emergency response and first-aid procedures (Section 8).
9. Incident reporting and the worker's right to raise safety concerns without retaliation.

SUPERINTENDENT/COMPETENT PERSON TRAINING

Individuals designated as the Superintendent/Competent Person shall additionally demonstrate:

- Use of Thermal Hygrometers
- Use of Anemometers
- Use of CO Monitors
- Reading and Applying the action Level and Work/Warm-Up Tables
- Evaluating Building Enclosure Status
- Authority and Procedure for Stopping Work & Activating Emergency Response

DOCUMENTAITON

- Training records shall include worker name, trainer name, date, topics, and worker signature (Appendix C).
- Toolbox-talk refresher training shall be conducted at least weekly during the cold-weather season and documented in the site safety log.

PLAN REVIEW & REVISION

- This plan shall be reviewed annually at minimum, prior to the start of each cold-weather season.
- Review is also triggered by any cold-related recordable incident, any CO alarm event, any OSHA inspection finding, or significant change in project scope, crew composition, or building enclosure status.
- All revisions shall be documented in the revision history and communicated to all Division 06 personnel before the revised plan takes effect.

REVISION HISTORY

Revision Number	Date	Description of Change	Approval
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			